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PFBC notes stocking exemptions on wild trout streams, other changes



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Key Points

- Several stream sections were added to the state's list of Class A wild trout streams.
- Temporary fishing regulation changes were made for several lakes ahead of dam rehabilitation projects.
- The commission approved 13 trout stocking exemptions on Class A wild trout streams for events like fishing derbies.

The Pennsylvania Fish and Boat Commission reviewed fishing regulation changes to several waterways and stocking exemptions on some wild trout streams during its Jan. 30 meeting.

The board approved several changes and reviewed regulatory changes for other waterways made by the staff including the following:

The commissioners voted to remove Blue Hole Creek, Section 02, Somerset County, from the Stocked Trout Waters (STW) Open to Year-round Fishing program. In 2025, the PFBC was notified by the Pennsylvania Department of Environmental Protection (DEP) that a survey had documented high concentrations of cadmium and lead in a portion of Blue Hole Creek.

The PFBC voted to discontinue trout stocking in the area because of potential health safety concerns.

More: 2026 trout stocking schedule released, 5 waters added, 9 removed in Pa.

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Trout background: Here's why few brook trout, Pennsylvania's state fish, are stocked

Fishing regulations lifted temporarily

Temporary changes to fishing regulations were enacted on several lakes in anticipation of upcoming dam rehabilitation projects. Regulations regarding seasons, sizes and creel limits have been lifted on Fords Lake, Lackawanna County; Harris Pond, Luzerne County; Rose Valley Lake, Lycoming County; and Tobyhanna Lake, Monroe County.

Stocking exemptions for Class A Wild Trout Streams

Tim Schaeffer, executive director of the agency, approved 13 trout stocking exemptions for five years on 12 Class A wild trout stream sections for a variety of purposes like fishing derbies and private stockings. Eight of the requests were renewals and five are new exemptions. The exemptions include:

Renewal exemptions: Yellow Creek, Section 02, Bedford County; Unnamed tributary to Tulpehocken Creek (Womelsdorf), Section 02, Berks County; Wyomissing Creek, Section 03, Berks County; Beaver Run, Section 01, Clearfield County; Letort Spring Run, Section 03, Cumberland County; Warriors Mark Run, Section 01, Huntingdon County, and Marvin Creek, Section 01, McKean County;.

New exemptions: Clover Creek, Section 03, Blair County; Penns Creek, Section 01, Centre County; Dotters Creek, Section 02, Monroe County; Dotters Creek, Section 02, Monroe County, and Monocacy Creek, Section 02, Northampton County.

Class A wild trout streams

The board approved the addition of three waterways to the PFBC's list of Class A wild trout streams, including sections of Beaverdam Run in Cambria County, Little Fishing Creek in Centre County and Buffalo Creek in Union County.

Riggles Gap Run in Blair County and Little Mill Creek in Lycoming County were added to the PFBC's list of wild trout streams.

The board approved revising the wild trout designation on Flegals Run in Clearfield County to now include the entire waterway between the headwaters to the mouth. It's a tributary to Lick Run.

These additions and revisions will go into effect upon publication of a second notice in the Pennsylvania Bulletin.

Trout stocking schedules

The PFBC is preparing for preseason trout stocking operations in anticipation of the statewide Mentored Youth Trout Fishing Day on March 28 and the statewide Opening Day of Trout Season April 4.

The 2026 Adult Trout Stocking is available on the agency's website Fishandboat.com and anglers are reminded to revisit the stocking schedule frequently to remain aware of changes that may happen because of inclement weather and hatchery logistics.

The PFBC will stock roughly 3.2 million trout throughout the year. In addition to trout raised at state fish hatcheries, PFBC cooperative nurseries operated by sportsmen's clubs and other groups across the state will add another 1.1 million trout to waters open to public angling.

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